COLOSSIANS · STUDY 08 OF 12

# Colossians 3:1–11

## *Looking Up, Putting Off*

**Christ Is All — A Study of Colossians**

Small Group Bible Study Series · NASB95

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| ① Text | ② Devotional | ③ Commentary | ④ Self-Study Guide |
|---|---|---|---|
| Foundation | Personal preparation | Teacher / leader preparation | Group meeting |
| *Everyone* | *All group members* | *Teacher / leader* | *Small group* |

⑤ *Application closes each study and draws from all sections above.*

Time guide: about 30 minutes — Devotional 4 · Commentary 15 · Discussion 8 · Application 3.

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## ① BIBLICAL TEXT

*Colossians 3:1–11 · New American Standard Bible (NASB95)*

**3:1** *Therefore if you have been raised up with Christ, keep seeking the things above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God.*

**2** *Set your mind on the things above, not on the things that are on earth.*

**3** *For you have died and your life is hidden with Christ in God.*

**4** *When Christ, who is our life, is revealed, then you also will be revealed with Him in glory.*

**5** *Therefore consider the members of your earthly body as dead to immorality, impurity, passion, evil desire, and greed, which amounts to idolatry.*

**6** *For it is because of these things that the wrath of God will come upon the sons of disobedience,*

**7** *and in them you also once walked, when you were living in them.*

**8** *But now you also, put them all aside: anger, wrath, malice, slander, and abusive speech from your mouth.*

**9** *Do not lie to one another, since you laid aside the old self with its evil practices,*

**10** *and have put on the new self who is being renewed to a true knowledge according to the image of the One who created him—*

**11** *a renewal in which there is no distinction between Greek and Jew, circumcised and uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave and freeman, but Christ is all, and in all.*

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## ② DEVOTIONAL

*Personal preparation · Drawn from the outline of this study*

### Bring Your Practice Up to Your Position

> *"Therefore if you have been raised up with Christ, keep seeking the things above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God"*
>
> *— Colossians 3:1 (NASB95)*

For two chapters Paul has told us who Christ is and who we are in Him. Now comes the word "therefore." Because you have been raised with Christ, keep seeking the things above. Set your mind there. Your life is hidden with Christ in God, safe and secure, and one day, when He is revealed, you will be revealed with Him in glory.

That is our position. Paul now calls us to bring our practice up to it. The sins of the old life, impurity, greed, anger, malice, slander, and lying, do not fit the new life. They belong to who we were, not to who we are. So we treat them as dead and lay them aside like old clothes.

And in the new life there are no first-class and second-class believers. Greek and Jew, educated and uneducated, slave and free all stand on level ground, because Christ is all, and in all. No one has more of Christ than anyone else. The real question is how much of me Christ has.

#### For reflection

1. Where does your mind naturally go when it is not busy? Toward things above, or things on earth?
2. Which of the "old clothes" in verses 5–9 do you find yourself reaching for most often?
3. Is there anyone in your church you quietly treat as less important than yourself?

*You can't live the Christian life until you have the Christian life to live. If you have it, live it from above.*

## ③ COMMENTARY

*Teacher preparation resource · Full text organized under outline headings*

> **The passage teaches:** Since believers have been raised with Christ and their life is hidden with Him in God until He is revealed in glory, they must keep seeking and thinking about the things above, and so bring their practice up to their position by treating the old sins as dead, laying aside sinful attitudes and speech, and refusing every lie, including the lie of superiority, in a new life where Christ is all, and in all.

### Outline


- **I. The Life That Looks Up to Christ (3:1–4)**
  - A. The Requirement (3:1a)
  - B. The Responsibilities (3:1b–2)
  - C. The Reason (3:3)
  - D. The Reward (3:4)
- **II. Put to Death the Old Actions (3:5–7)**
  - A. What They Are (3:5)
  - B. Why They Are Wrong (3:6–7)
- **III. Put Aside the Old Attitudes (3:8)**
- **IV. Put Away the Old Lie (3:9–11)**
  - A. The Inconsistency of the Lie (3:9–10)
  - B. The Impossibility of the Lie (3:11)


## Introduction

As is his custom, Paul divides his letter into doctrine and practice. We can see the same pattern in Romans: righteousness needed (1:18–3:20), righteousness imputed (3:21–5:21), righteousness imparted (6–8), righteousness vindicated in God's dealings with Israel (9–11), and righteousness practiced (12–16). Romans 12:1 turns the corner with "therefore," and Colossians 3:1 does the same. Paul has given the doctrine in chapters 1–2. Now he tells us what to do about it.

Charles Ryrie used to say, "All doctrine should be practical. All practice should be doctrinal." In these closing chapters we find a string of commands, and every one of them rests on the doctrine already taught. This study covers two movements: the life that looks up to Christ (3:1–4) and the call to bring our practice up to our position (3:5–11).

## I. The Life That Looks Up to Christ (3:1–4)

### A. The Requirement (3:1a)

"Therefore if you have been raised up with Christ." The "if" here assumes the fact (a first class condition); the NIV renders it "Since, then." Paul is assuming the Colossians had been raised with Christ, and in their case it was true. He had said so in 2:12: they had been

"buried with Him in baptism, in which you were also raised up with Him through faith in the working of God."

Wherever this passage is taught, each listener should ask, "Have I been raised with Christ? Have I believed that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God (John 20:31), and His promise that whoever believes in Him has eternal life (John 3:16)?" You cannot live the Christian life until you have the Christian life to live. Before faith, we were "dead in [our] transgressions" (2:13) and had no relationship with God. At the moment of faith His life became our life. We are no longer part of this world's system; we are citizens of a higher realm (Phil. 3:20).

## B. The Responsibilities (3:1b–2)

### 1. Keep seeking the things above (3:1b)

"Keep seeking the things above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God." The present tense calls for an ongoing pursuit: keep on seeking. Your Savior is above, your home is above, your future is above. This command addresses the will and the heart's desire.

"Seated at the right hand of God" echoes Psalm 110:1, perhaps the Old Testament verse most quoted in the New Testament:

> *“The Lord says to my Lord:*
> *“Sit at My right hand*
> *Until I make Your enemies a footstool for Your feet.””*
> — Psalm 110:1 (NASB95)

The right hand is the place of honor and authority, and believers are seated with Him in the heavenly places (Eph. 1:3, 20; 2:6). Jesus is preparing a place for us (John 14:2–3), and Hebrews describes the heavenly city we have already "come to":

> *“But you have come to Mount Zion and to the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to myriads of angels, to the general assembly and church of the firstborn who are enrolled in heaven, and to God, the Judge of all, and to the spirits of the righteous made perfect, and to Jesus, the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood, which speaks better than the blood of Abel.”*
> — Hebrews 12:22–24 (NASB95)

How would you fit in with that company? It is worth preparing for now.

### 2. Set your mind on the things above (3:2)

"Set your mind on the things above, not on the things that are on earth." Paul shifts from the will to the mind. The verb (*phroneite*) means to think, to have an attitude, to be intent on. This is the idea behind Philippians 4:8: "whatever is true … honorable … right … pure … lovely … of good repute … dwell on these things."

What are "the things above"? Chapter 2 has already named some of them: the cancellation of our debt (2:14), the treasures of wisdom and knowledge hidden in Christ (2:3), and the supply from the Head that makes the body grow with the growth from God (2:19). We can define them by contrast with "the things on earth," the visible, material concerns the false

teachers were so busy with: foods, days, and rules. Those teachers acted as though earthly things could make a believer lose or fail to find his life in Christ. Paul says, in effect, "In Christ you have life, and you cannot lose it. Now concentrate on growing in Christ and glorifying Him with that life."

### C. The Reason (3:3)

#### 1. You died

"For you have died." You died to the world's religious system with all its philosophy (2:8), its manner of worship (2:18, 23), and its decrees (2:20–21). These things are visible and earthly. What does it matter to a dead man what anyone does with material, earthly things? But this death led to life through our resurrection with Christ, a life the false teachers knew nothing about.

#### 2. Your life is hidden with Christ in God

"And your life is hidden with Christ in God." God raised Christ to a life of infinite glory and raised us with Him. "Hidden" (perfect tense: hidden and remaining hidden) implies both concealment and safety. The world cannot see it, and no one can take it.

> *“Beloved, now we are children of God, and it has not appeared as yet what we will be. We know that when He appears, we will be like Him, because we will see Him just as He is.”*
>
> — 1 John 3:2 (NASB95)

### D. The Reward (3:4)

"When Christ, who is our life, is revealed, then you also will be revealed with Him in glory." Christ is "our life" (compare Phil. 1:21, "to live is Christ"). He is invisible to the world now, and so is our life with Him. But He will be made visible, and at that moment our life will be made visible too. Paul uses the same verb (*phaneroō*, passive) for both: when He is revealed, we will be revealed. This takes place at His coming for His Church (1 Thess. 4:13–17; 1 Cor. 15:51–52), and Scripture links that time with the evaluation and rewarding of believers.

But even the crowns and honors will fade in the light of His glory. Anne Ross Cousin captured it in the hymn "The Sands of Time Are Sinking":

> *“The bride eyes not her garment, / But her dear Bridegroom's face; / I will not gaze at glory / But on my King of grace. / Not at the crown He giveth / But on His pierced hand; / The Lamb is all the glory / Of Immanuel's land.”*
>
> — Anne Ross Cousin (1857)

## II. Put to Death the Old Actions (3:5–7)

"Therefore." Because your life is hidden with Christ in God and you will appear with Him in glory, bring your practice up to your position.

## A. What They Are (3:5)

"Therefore consider the members of your earthly body as dead." The NKJV reads "put to death your members." This does not mean to cut off your hand or pluck out your eye. Jesus used that strong language (Matt. 5:29–30) to show how serious sin is, not to command self-mutilation. Here "members" stands for the sinful acts our members commit, just as we say, "Don't give me any of your lip." Paul names five sins:

- **Immorality** (*porneia*): every kind of sexual sin, including prostitution and all unlawful sexual intercourse.
- **Impurity** (*akatharsia*): uncleanness, in this context sexual uncleanness of a wider kind, including perversions.
- **Passion** (*pathos*): uncontrolled lust. This person does not wait for temptation to find him; he goes looking for it.
- **Evil desire** (*epithymia kakē*): craving for the forbidden, the desires that ruled us "in your ignorance" (1 Pet. 1:14).
- **Greed** (*pleonexia*), "which amounts to idolatry": the itch to have more, including what belongs to someone else. The tenth commandment names the neighbor's house, his wife, and all that is his (Exod. 20:17).

Trench observed that these five move from the more specific to the more comprehensive. Can believers commit these sins? Of course; why else would Paul forbid them in a letter to believers? Should they? No! But we need to know that it is possible, so we will not be blindsided by it.

When people keep ignoring God's Word, God gives them over to their own lusts. Romans 1:21–28 traces that sad progression three times: "God gave them over … God gave them over … God gave them over."

How can we avoid these sins? Call sin by its real name: not love, but lust. Do not send out wrong signals; be modest in dress and manner. Think proper thoughts, because the thought is the mother of the deed. Stay out of compromising situations. And flee: "Flee immorality" (1 Cor. 6:18). Joseph ran from Potiphar's wife (Gen. 39:12).

## B. Why They Are Wrong (3:6–7)

### 1. They bring the wrath of God

"For it is because of these things that the wrath of God will come upon the sons of disobedience." God's wrath is His settled displeasure and judgment on sin. "Sons of disobedience" (included in the NASB95, though absent from some manuscripts) refers to unbelievers, as in Ephesians 2:2. Paul is not threatening believers with hell. He is showing how seriously God regards these sins. God hates them. Seeing God's opinion of these sins is the number one reason we should not come near them, but flee from them as fast as we can.

### 2. They belong to the old life

"And in them you also once walked, when you were living in them." That is past tense. These things described who you were, not who you are. Read 3:1–4 again, and see how out of place they are for someone raised with Christ.

## III. Put Aside the Old Attitudes (3:8)

"But now you also, put them all aside." The verb pictures taking off clothes. Paul names five more, and the last phrase, "from your mouth," shows that all of them come out in our speech:

- **Anger** (*orgē*): a settled, abiding attitude of anger, often with a desire for revenge.
- **Wrath** (*thymos*): the boiling over, an outburst of rage.
- **Malice** (*kakia*): a vicious, mean-spirited disposition, ill will that wants to harm. It is the root beneath anger and rage.
- **Slander** (*blasphēmia*): abusive speech that defames and denigrates others.
- **Abusive speech** (*aischrologia*): low, obscene talk, foul-mouthed language. It occurs only here in the New Testament.

## IV. Put Away the Old Lie (3:9–11)

"Do not lie to one another." This command begins a new sentence that runs through verse 11. Lying in every form is incompatible with the new life. And the flow of the sentence suggests one lie in particular that does not belong in the body of Christ: the lie that some believers are more important than others. That is a kind of arrogance, and verses 9–11 show why it is both inconsistent and impossible.

### A. The Inconsistency of the Lie (3:9–10)

#### 1. You have laid aside the old self (3:9)

"Since you laid aside the old self with its evil practices." This is a past fact (aorist). The old self, who we were in Adam, was put off at salvation.

#### 2. You have put on the new self (3:10)

"And have put on the new self who is being renewed to a true knowledge according to the image of the One who created him." The new self is being renewed (present tense, continually) "to a true knowledge" (*epignōsis*, the very thing Paul prayed for in 1:9). That renewal happens as a believer comes to a personal, deep knowledge of and fellowship with Christ. "Our inner man is being renewed day by day" (2 Cor. 4:16).

And it is "according to the image of the One who created him." When God created man, He made him in His image and gave him dominion (Gen. 1:27–28). Sin marred that image. Hebrews 2:8–9 admits, "we do not yet see all things subjected to him. But we do see Him … Jesus." In Christ, the image is being restored.

## B. The Impossibility of the Lie (3:11)

### 1. There is no elite in Christ

"A renewal in which there is no distinction between Greek and Jew, circumcised and uncircumcised, barbarian, Scythian, slave and freeman." Paul sweeps away four kinds of distinction:

- **Racial:** Greek and Jew.
- **Religious and ceremonial:** circumcised and uncircumcised.
- **Cultural and educational:** barbarian (anyone who did not speak Greek) and Scythian (regarded as the crudest of barbarians).
- **Social:** slave and freeman.

These distinctions still exist in the world. But in the new humanity, the body of Christ, they give no one higher standing before God.

### 2. Christ is all, and in all

"But Christ is all." He is all in three areas. In **salvation**: there is no place for angelic mediators (1:18–22; 2:18). In **sanctification**: legalism and asceticism are out of place, because He is our life (2:16–23; 3:3–4). In **satisfaction**: there is no need for philosophy or the deeds of the old self (1:26–28; 2:3, 9–10). He fills the whole of life, and everything else is a hindrance.

"And in all." Christ indwells every believer. No one has more of Christ than anyone else. The real question is: how much of me does Christ have?

# Conclusion

Paul's practical teaching begins by lifting our eyes. Seek the things above, which stresses the desire of the heart. Set your mind on the things above, which stresses the focus of our thoughts. Then, from that height, look at the old clothes we used to wear: immorality, greed, anger, slander, lying, and pride. They do not fit anymore.

Bring your practice up to your position. You have died, your life is hidden with Christ in God, and one day you will be revealed with Him in glory. Until then, Christ is all, and in all.

*Lord, thank You.*

# ④ SELF-STUDY GUIDE

*For use during the group meeting · Focused on the commentary text*

## Greek Word Study

*Grammar and parsing: Blue Letter Bible. Sources cited selectively: STR (Strong's), THAY (Thayer's), ATR (A. T. Robertson), VINE (Vine's), MRV (Vincent's), LXX (Septuagint usage).*

| Verse | Greek Word (Lexical Form) / English | Strong's # / Transliteration / Form | Definition & Significance |
|---|---|---|---|
| v.1 | **συνεγείρω**<br>*raised up with* | **G4891**<br>*synegeirō*<br>Aor. Pass. Ind. 2nd Pl. | **ATR:** with *ei*, a first class condition: "since you were raised."<br>**Significance:** The doctrinal ground of all the commands that follow. |
| v.1 | **ζητέω**<br>*keep seeking* | **G2212**<br>*zēteō*<br>Pres. Act. Imp. 2nd Pl. | **ATR:** present imperative: keep on seeking.<br>**Significance:** A continual pursuit of the heart and will toward Christ above. |
| v.2 | **φρονέω**<br>*set your mind* | **G5426**<br>*phroneō*<br>Pres. Act. Imp. 2nd Pl. | **THAY:** to think, be minded, direct one's mind to.<br>**Significance:** The mind as well as the will is to be fixed on things above. |
| v.3 | **κρύπτω**<br>*hidden* | **G2928**<br>*kryptō*<br>Perf. Pass. Ind. 3rd Sg. | **ATR:** perfect: hidden and remaining hidden.<br>**Significance:** The believer's life is concealed from the world and secure in God. |
| v.4 | **φανερόω**<br>*revealed* | **G5319**<br>*phaneroō*<br>Aor. Pass. Subj. 3rd Sg. / Fut. Pass. Ind. 2nd Pl. | **VINE:** to make visible, manifest.<br>**Significance:** When He is revealed, we will be revealed with Him in glory. |
| v.5 | **νεκρόω**<br>*consider as dead* | **G3499**<br>*nekroō*<br>Aor. Act. Imp. 2nd Pl. | **THAY:** to put to death, deprive of power.<br>**Significance:** A decisive act: treat the old sinful practices as dead. |
| v.5 | **πορνεία**<br>*immorality* | **G4202**<br>*porneia*<br>Acc. Fem. Sg. | **THAY:** illicit sexual intercourse of every kind.<br>**Significance:** Heads a list moving from specific to comprehensive. |
| v.5 | **πλεονεξία**<br>*greed* | **G4124**<br>*pleonexia*<br>Acc. Fem. Sg. | **VINE:** the desire to have more; covetousness.<br>**Significance:** Greed "amounts to idolatry": wanting things more than God. |
| v.8 | **ὀργή**<br>*anger* | **G3709**<br>*orgē*<br>Acc. Fem. Sg. | **VINE:** a settled, abiding condition of mind, often with revenge in view.<br>**Significance:** The slow burn, distinguished from the outburst (*thymos*). |
| v.8 | **θυμός**<br>*wrath* | **G2372**<br>*thymos*<br>Acc. Fem. Sg. | **THAY:** passion, boiling agitation of feelings.<br>**Significance:** The flare-up of rage. |
| v.8 | **κακία**<br>*malice* | **G2549**<br>*kakia*<br>Acc. Fem. Sg. | **STR:** badness, ill will, desire to injure.<br>**Significance:** The root beneath anger and rage. |

| Verse | Greek Word (Lexical Form) / English | Strong's # / Transliteration / Form | Definition & Significance |
|---|---|---|---|
| v.8 | **αἰσχρολογία**<br>*abusive speech* | **G148**<br>*aischrologia*<br>Acc. Fem. Sg. | **ATR:** low and obscene speech; only here in the NT.<br>**Significance:** Foul talk has no place in the mouth of the new self. |
| v.9 | **ἀπεκδύομαι**<br>*laid aside* | **G554**<br>*apekdyomai*<br>Aor. Mid. Ptc. Nom. Masc. Pl. | **VINE:** to strip off, as clothing (cf. 2:15).<br>**Significance:** The old self was put off at salvation; live accordingly. |
| v.10 | **ἀνακαινόω**<br>*being renewed* | **G341**<br>*anakainoō*<br>Pres. Pass. Ptc. Acc. Masc. Sg. | **ATR:** present: a continual renewal (cf. 2 Cor. 4:16).<br>**Significance:** The new self keeps being renewed toward true knowledge and God's image. |

**Grammar key** — Cases: Nom. · Gen. · Dat. · Acc. · Voc. | Number: Sg. · Pl. | Gender: Masc. · Fem. · Neut. Verb Mood: Ind. · Imp. · Subj. · Opt. · Inf. · Ptc. | Tense: Pres. · Imperf. · Fut. · Aor. · Perf. · Plpf. | Voice: Act. · Mid. · Pass. | Person: 1st/2nd/3rd Sg./Pl.

# Study Questions

## Part 1 — From the Commentary

| Review prompt | From the commentary |
|---|---|
| What does "therefore" in 3:1 signal? | The shift from doctrine (chs. 1–2) to practice (chs. 3–4). |
| How do "seek" (v.1) and "set your mind" (v.2) differ? | Seeking stresses the will and desire; setting the mind stresses thinking and focus. |
| What does "hidden with Christ in God" imply? | Both concealment from the world and security in God. |
| Name the five sins of 3:5. | Immorality, impurity, passion, evil desire, greed (idolatry). |
| Name the four distinctions removed in 3:11. | Racial, religious-ceremonial, cultural-educational, social. |

## Part 2 — Study Questions

1. Why must a person be "raised with Christ" before he can obey 3:1–2?

> **Leader's answer:** You cannot live the Christian life until you have the Christian life to live. The commands assume new life received by faith (2:12–13); they describe how that life is lived, not how it is obtained.

2. How did the false teachers' focus on "things on earth" (foods, days, rules) contrast with what Paul commands?

> **Leader's answer:** They were preoccupied with visible, material religion. Paul directs believers to the unseen realities in Christ: forgiveness, wisdom, and the Head's supply. Believers died to the world's system, so earthly rules have no claim on them.

3. According to this study, does the warning of wrath in 3:6 threaten believers with hell?

> **Leader's answer:** No. "Sons of disobedience" refers to unbelievers (Eph. 2:2). The warning shows how seriously God regards these sins; believers should flee them because God hates them and because they belong to the old life.

4. Why do all five sins of 3:8 relate to the mouth?

> **Leader's answer:** The phrase "from your mouth" ties them together: anger, wrath, and malice show up in slander and foul talk. What the heart holds, the mouth eventually speaks.

5. What does "Christ is all, and in all" mean for how we treat other believers?

> **Leader's answer:** No believer has more of Christ or higher standing than another; distinctions of race, religion, culture, and class give no spiritual rank. The question is not how much of Christ I have, but how much of me He has.

## Part 3 — Passage Summary

| Verses | Theme | Key truth |
|---|---|---|
| 3:1–2 | Look up | Since raised with Christ, keep seeking and thinking on things above. |
| 3:3–4 | The reason and reward | You died; your life is hidden with Christ; you will be revealed with Him in glory. |
| 3:5–7 | Put to death | Treat immorality, impurity, passion, evil desire, and greed as dead. |
| 3:8 | Put aside | Lay aside anger, wrath, malice, slander, and abusive speech. |
| 3:9–11 | Put away the lie | The new self is being renewed; in Christ there are no distinctions; Christ is all. |

## ⑤ APPLICATION

*Closes the study · personal and corporate*

### 1. Retrain Your Thought Life

**Scripture anchor:** Colossians 3:2; Philippians 4:8

*Source: Draws from ③ Commentary, I.B.2*

Setting the mind on things above is a discipline, not a feeling. What we feed our minds shapes our desires, and our desires shape our actions. The things above are the realities of Christ and His work; the things on earth are the passing concerns that crowd Him out.

**Reflection:** What occupies your mind most in the first and last hour of each day?

**Practical step:** Replace fifteen minutes of screen time each day this week with reading or meditating on Colossians 3:1–4.

### 2. Call Sin by Its Name and Flee

**Scripture anchor:** Colossians 3:5; 1 Corinthians 6:18

*Source: Draws from ③ Commentary, II.A*

Sexual sin and greed rarely ambush us without warning. They grow from thoughts entertained, signals sent, and situations not avoided. Joseph did not debate temptation; he ran. Treating sin as dead means refusing to give it oxygen.

**Reflection:** Is there a situation, habit, or relationship that repeatedly puts you in the path of temptation?

**Practical step:** Take one concrete step this week to remove or avoid a source of temptation, and tell a trusted believer about it.

### 3. Guard Your Mouth

**Scripture anchor:** Colossians 3:8–9

*Source: Draws from ③ Commentary, III and IV*

Anger, wrath, malice, slander, abusive speech, and lying all come out through the mouth. Speech is often the first place our old clothes show. Putting them off includes learning to stop, pray, and choose words that fit the new self.

**Reflection:** Which of these sins of the mouth is most common for you: in traffic, at home, online?

**Practical step:** Ask a family member or close friend to point out one time this week when your speech did not fit the new self.

### 4. Let Christ Have All of You

**Scripture anchor:** Colossians 3:11

*Source: Draws from ③ Commentary, IV.B, and ② Devotional; cf. Ryrie, Balancing the Christian Life (FGR)*

Every believer has all of Christ. Spiritual maturity is a matter of yielding more of ourselves to Him. Ryrie's Balancing the Christian Life describes the Spirit-filled life as a matter of control: not getting more of the Spirit, but the Spirit having more of us.

**Reflection:** What area of your life is Christ still waiting to be given?

**Practical step:** Write down one area you have held back from Christ and pray each day this week, "Lord, have all of me here."

*End of Study · Colossians 3:1–11*